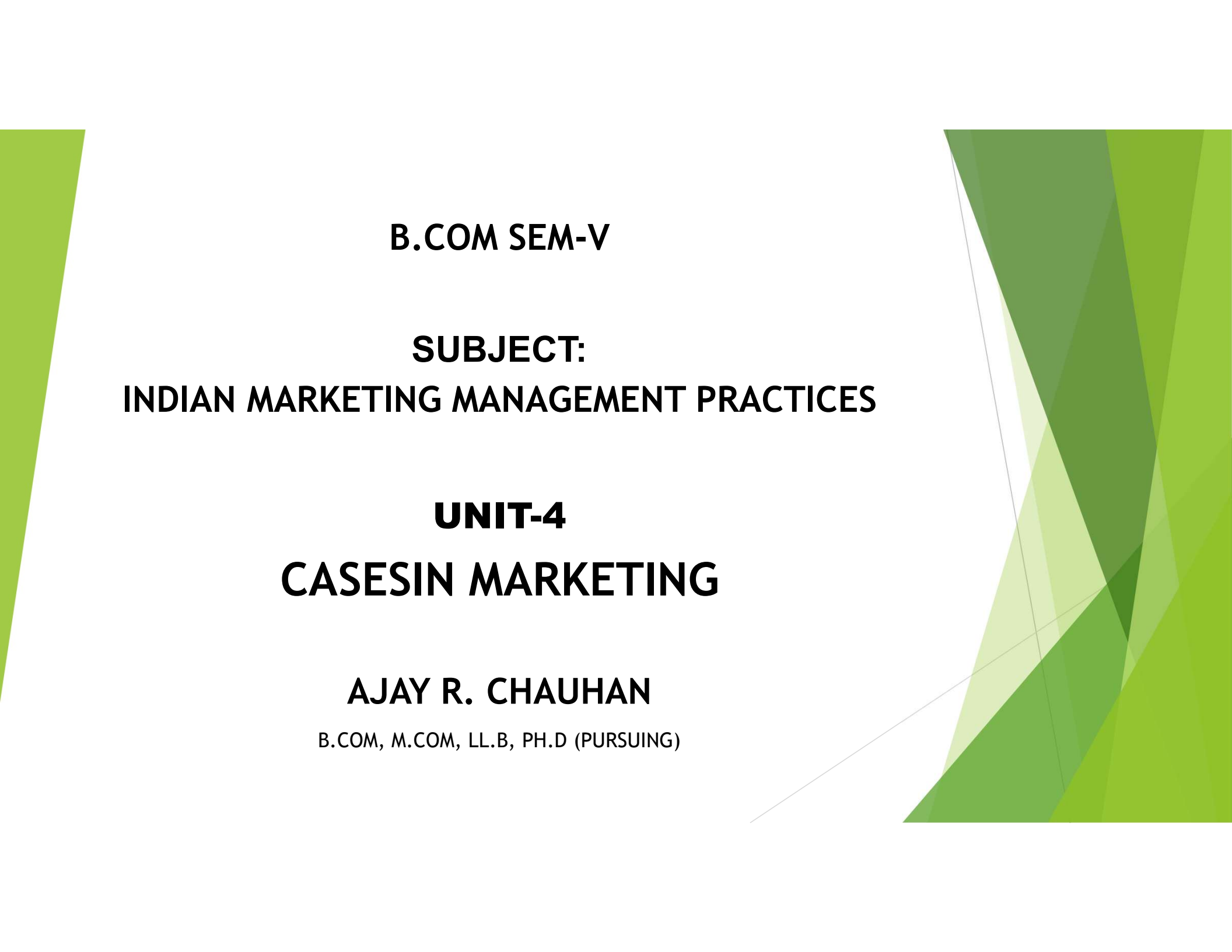




B.COM SEM-V

SUBJECT:
INDIAN MARKETING MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

UNIT-4
CASES IN MARKETING

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► INTRODUCTION AND MEANING OF CASES IN MARKETING

- In business education and managerial decision-making, marketing cannot be understood purely through theoretical concepts and textbook definitions. **Cases in Marketing** (or the Case Study Method in Marketing) serve as a practical learning and analytical framework that bridges the gap between marketing theory and real-world business practice. By analyzing real-life or realistic business situations, marketers and students develop critical thinking, problem-solving, and decision-making skills.
- **1. Introduction to Cases in Marketing**
- The case study method in marketing originated at Harvard Business School and has since become a cornerstone of marketing management education worldwide. In traditional learning, concepts like market segmentation, pricing strategies, and promotional mixes are taught theoretically. However, real-world markets are uncertain, dynamic, and complex. "Cases in Marketing" introduce learners to actual business scenarios faced by corporate managers—such as declining sales, new product launches, competitive threats, or brand crises. Instead of giving a single pre-determined answer, marketing cases require managers and students to diagnose business problems, evaluate market data, weigh alternative strategies, and formulate actionable recommendations.

► 2. Meaning and Academic Definition of a Marketing Case

- A **Marketing Case** is a detailed, written account of a real-world or realistic business situation, challenge, or opportunity encountered by an organization, designed to serve as a basis for analysis, discussion, and strategic decision-making. It provides comprehensive context regarding the company's internal resources, competitor strategies, consumer behavior trends, financial data, and market environment. According to general management literature, *a case study is an empirical inquiry that investigates a contemporary phenomenon within its real-life context*. In short, a marketing case presents a scenario where a marketer must answer: "What is the core problem, and what should the company do next?"

► OBJECTIVES OF CASE METHOD

- The **Case Method** in marketing education and managerial training is a participant-centered learning framework designed to simulate real-world decision-making. Rather than relying on passive textbook lectures, the case method places students in the role of corporate decision-makers facing complex business scenarios. The primary objective of this approach is to transform theoretical knowledge into actionable, practical business acumen.

► 1. Bridging the Gap Between Marketing Theory and Practical Execution

- The foremost objective of the case method is to connect academic marketing theories with real-world corporate execution. While textbooks explain concepts like market positioning, pricing elasticities, or channel distribution in isolated environments, real business markets are messy, unpredictable, and dynamic. The case method requires learners to apply theoretical frameworks—such as SWOT Analysis, the 4 Ps, and Porter's Five Forces—to authentic business scenarios, helping them understand how theoretical principles function when tested against real market constraints.

► 2. Developing Critical Thinking and Problem-Diagnostic Skills

- In real-world business, management problems rarely arrive with neat labels or obvious causes. A key objective of the case method is to train learners to look beyond surface symptoms—such as declining sales volume—and diagnose the underlying root causes, such as poor product positioning, changing consumer demographics, or aggressive competitor pricing. Through rigorous case analysis, individuals learn to filter out irrelevant background noise, structure ambiguous information, and identify core business challenges logically.

▶ **3. Enhancing Quantitative and Qualitative Data Analysis Skills**

- ▶ Modern marketing decisions rely heavily on interpreting complex data sets. Case studies present learners with diverse data sources—including financial balance sheets, market share tables, consumer survey results, and competitor pricing grids. A major objective of the case method is to build analytical competence by forcing participants to analyze both quantitative metrics (such as profit margins and customer acquisition costs) and qualitative factors (such as brand perception and customer sentiment) before arriving at strategic conclusions.

▶ **4. Cultivating Decision-Making Under Uncertainty**

- ▶ In commercial environments, corporate leaders must routinely make high-stakes strategic choices based on incomplete, conflicting, or ambiguous information. The case method aims to build confidence and decisiveness under uncertain conditions. It teaches learners that there is rarely a single "perfect" textbook answer; instead, managers must weigh alternative courses of action, evaluate trade-offs, assess risk profiles, and commit to a clear strategic path backed by logical arguments.

► 5. Fostering Strategic Foresight and Alternative Evaluation

- A critical objective of the case study method is encouraging long-term strategic foresight rather than quick, short-term fixes. When evaluating a case, participants must generate multiple strategic options (e.g., launching a low-cost product line vs. expanding into international markets) and systematically evaluate the short-term and long-term consequences of each alternative. This process trains future managers to anticipate competitor responses, evaluate resource allocation risks, and align operational tactics with overall corporate strategy.

► 6. Improving Communication, Persuasion, and Team Collaboration

- Marketing management is inherently collaborative and requires convincing stakeholders, board members, and team members to support a proposed strategy. The case method uses classroom discussions, group presentations, and debates to sharpen communication skills. Participants learn to articulate their analytical reasoning clearly, defend their strategic recommendations against counter-arguments, listen to diverse perspectives, and collaborate within team settings to reach consensus on business solutions.

► BENEFITS OF CASE METHOD

- The **Case Method** is widely recognized as one of the most effective pedagogical tools in marketing education and professional management training. By immersing learners in realistic business scenarios, the case method offers unique cognitive, practical, and interpersonal benefits that traditional lecture-based learning cannot replicate.
- **1. Active and Participant-Centered Learning**
 - One of the greatest benefits of the case method is that it shifts the learning environment from passive listening to active engagement. Instead of passively taking notes on theoretical definitions, learners step into the shoes of corporate executives, brand managers, or entrepreneurs. This active involvement increases attention retention, stimulates intellectual curiosity, and makes the learning process far more dynamic and memorable compared to standard textbook instruction.
- **2. Real-World Decision Simulation Without Financial Risk**
 - The case method acts as a risk-free simulator for complex business management. In real markets, a flawed product launch, bad pricing strategy, or mismanaged PR crisis can cost a company millions of dollars and ruin brand reputation

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- ▶ . Analyzing case studies allows learners to experiment with high-stakes decisions, evaluate risk factors, and witness the logical consequences of their strategic choices in a safe classroom environment where mistakes serve as valuable learning opportunities rather than costly business failures.
 - ▶ **3. Exposure to Diverse Industries and Business Models**
 - ▶ Through the case method, learners gain broad exposure to a wide variety of industries, organizational structures, and business models in a relatively short period. Over the course of an academic term, a student might evaluate a tech startup's go-to-market strategy, an FMCG company's supply chain crisis, an airline's pricing model, and a luxury brand's digital transformation. This cross-industry exposure broadens managerial perspective, helping learners understand how marketing principles apply across different commercial sectors.
 - ▶ **4. Development of Pragmatic Problem-Solving Abilities**
 - ▶ Unlike standardized exam questions that feature straightforward formulas or single right answers, real-world business challenges are messy, ambiguous, and multi-faceted. The case method helps develop pragmatic problem-solving abilities by teaching learners how to break down complex business problems into manageable parts. Participants learn to separate underlying root causes from superficial symptoms, organize fragmented data, and formulate practical, step-by-step action plans that are realistic to execute.

► 5. Sharpening of Argumentation and Persuasive Skills

- In the corporate world, having a great idea is not enough—managers must also persuade colleagues, board members, and clients to support and fund it. The case method sharpens communication and persuasive skills through structured classroom debate. Participants are required to defend their strategic recommendations using evidence from the case text, field data, and logical reasoning, while remaining open to constructive criticism and alternative viewpoints from peers.

► 6. Preparation for High-Pressure Executive Roles

- Finally, the case method builds the psychological readiness required for modern corporate leadership. Executive roles demand fast analytical thinking, comfort with ambiguity, and the ability to make firm decisions under tight deadlines with incomplete information. By routinely working through complex scenarios under time constraints, learners build managerial confidence, analytical agility, and strategic foresight—qualities directly sought after by corporate recruiters and business leaders.

► **DEVELOPING A CASE STUDY**

- **Developing a case study** is the systematic process of researching, structuring, writing, and presenting a detailed real-world or realistic business scenario for academic learning, decision-making, or corporate marketing. Whether built for business education (to teach students how to analyze complex market problems) or for corporate B2B marketing (to demonstrate how a company solved a client's problem), developing a case study requires structured research, clear data gathering, strategic problem definition, and compelling narrative building.
- **1. Identifying the Purpose, Target Audience, and Core Theme**
- The initial phase of developing a case study involves defining its primary objective and target audience. Authors must decide whether the case study is intended for academic pedagogical evaluation (such as a B.Com/MBA classroom case exploring a strategic brand failure) or as corporate sales collateral (proving how a product brought high ROI to a client). Establishing a clear focus—such as crisis management, digital transformation, international market expansion, or pricing strategy—ensures that the narrative remains focused on a specific managerial challenge rather than overwhelming the reader with irrelevant background data.

► 2. Primary and Secondary Data Collection

- Developing an authentic case study requires thorough empirical research and data gathering. Authors collect primary data through field interviews with corporate executives, brand managers, operational staff, or clients, capturing qualitative quotes and insider perspectives. Simultaneously, secondary data is gathered from published financial reports, market research databases, trade journals, customer review portals, and news archives. Collecting both quantitative metrics (such as sales figures, profit margins, and market share percentages) and qualitative insights (such as brand perception and workplace culture) ensures the case study is grounded in real-world business realities.

► 3. Structuring the Core Problem and Business Context

- A well-developed case study must establish a clear context and highlight a central business problem or decision point. Authors introduce the subject company, its history, industry dynamics, target demographics, and competitive environment. The narrative then focuses on the core dilemma—such as declining market share, an aggressive low-cost rival, a product recall crisis, or an entry barrier in a foreign market. Framing this problem clearly gives readers a central dilemma to analyze and solve.

► 4. Integrating Strategic Frameworks and Data Exhibits

- To make a case study analytically valuable, developers embed real business data and analytical frameworks into the text. Quantitative data is presented using tables, graphs, financial balance sheets, and market share charts as appended "Exhibits". Furthermore, the case scenario is written so that readers can apply standard business frameworks—such as SWOT Analysis, Porter's Five Forces, the 4 Ps Marketing Mix, or Ansoff's Growth Matrix—to evaluate the company's internal capabilities and external market threats.

► 5. Writing the Narrative using a Storytelling Approach

- The actual writing phase relies heavily on effective business storytelling. A dry, text-heavy report fails to engage readers; therefore, case developers use a clear narrative arc consisting of an opening context, rising tension (the problem), a decision-making crossroads, and either a resolution or an open-ended question. Incorporating direct quotes from decision-makers, setting realistic timelines, and presenting contrasting strategic viewpoints creates a realistic scenario that reflects actual corporate boardroom discussions.

► 6. Developing Teaching Notes (for Academic Cases)

- For academic case studies used in universities, developing a comprehensive **Teaching Note (TN)** is an essential final step. The teaching note serves as an instructor's guide, outlining the case's learning objectives, target courses, suggested pedagogical discussion flow, and theoretical concepts. It provides model answers to the case discussion questions, detailed financial calculations, suggested board plans, and classroom timing guides, helping faculty facilitate productive case discussions.

► 7. Review, Approval, and Ethical Compliance

- Before publishing or distributing a developed case study, authors must ensure legal, ethical, and organizational compliance. If the case study is based on a real company using primary field research, the final manuscript must undergo corporate review and formal sign-off to protect trade secrets and sensitive financial information. In cases where companies prefer to remain anonymous, case developers "disguise" the case by altering the company name, exact financial scales, or geographic location while preserving the underlying strategic challenge.

▶ **MARKETING CASE STUDIES**

▶ **CASE STUDY 1: GUJARAT STATE TOURISM DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD (GSTDC)**

▶ **1. Case Background and Operational Context**

- ▶ The **Gujarat State Tourism Development Corporation Ltd (GSTDC)** is a state-government undertaking responsible for developing, promoting, and regulating tourism infrastructure across Gujarat. Despite boasting rich heritage sites, wildlife sanctuaries (such as the Gir National Park), religious centers (Somnath, Dwarka), and unique geographical landforms (the Rann of Kutch), Gujarat historically lagged behind states like Rajasthan, Kerala, and Goa in domestic and international tourist arrivals. Tourism in the state suffered from low consumer awareness, limited hospitality infrastructure, and a lack of unified destination branding.

▶ **2. Core Problem and Strategic Challenges**

- ▶ Prior to 2010, GSTDC faced three fundamental marketing challenges:
- ▶ **Perceptual Barrier:** Gujarat was primarily perceived as a business or industrial state rather than a holiday destination.

- ▶ **Low Visitor Retention:** Most visitors were business travelers or religious pilgrims who undertook short, single-day visits with low overall expenditure.
- ▶ **Underutilized Heritage Assets:** Diverse tourism products—including eco-tourism, beach tourism, and handicrafts—lacked integrated promotion and market reach.
- ▶ **3. Marketing Strategy and Implementation ("Khushboo Gujarat Ki" Campaign)**
- ▶ To revamp the state's tourism footprint, GSTDC executed an integrated destination marketing campaign centered around the iconic multi-media campaign "**Khushboo Gujarat Ki**" (Scent of Gujarat).
- ▶ **Celebrity Endorsement and Narrative Positioning:** GSTDC appointed Bollywood icon Amitabh Bachchan as the brand ambassador. The television advertisements featured him personally guiding viewers through Gujarat's history, culture, wildlife, and natural landscapes, adding immense trust, storytelling appeal, and brand equity.
- ▶ **Event-Based Tourism Promotion:** GSTDC elevated local cultural events into national and international festivals, such as the multi-month **Rann Utsav** in Kutch, the **International Kite Festival (Uttarayan)** in Ahmedabad, and the **Navratri Festival**.
- ▶ **Infra-Development and PPP Model:** Simultaneously, GSTDC upgraded heritage homestays, improved transport connectivity, and partnered with private hotel chains to build hospitality infrastructure across rural and eco-tourism circuits.

► 4. Key Takeaways and Analytical Results

- **Exponential Traffic Growth:** Annual tourist arrivals in Gujarat jumped from under 10 million in the mid-2000s to over 50 million within a decade, turning tourism into a major contributor to state GDP.
- **Lessons in Destination Marketing:** The case proves that combining strong emotional storytelling, high-credibility brand ambassadors, and structured event management can successfully rebrand an entire geographic region.

► CASE STUDY 2: RUDI - THE GUJARAT MODEL OF RURAL DISTRIBUTION NETWORK

► 1. Case Background and Operational Context

- The Rural Urban Distribution Initiative (RUDI) was established in 2004 by the **Self Employed Women's Association (SEWA)** in Gujarat. RUDI is a community-owned, social-enterprise supply chain model designed to solve a dual economic problem in rural India: marginal farmers receiving unremunerative prices for agricultural produce due to middleman exploitation, and rural consumers paying high prices for poor-quality food products brought from urban centers.

► 2. The Micro-Enterprise Distribution Framework

- The RUDI model functions as a closed-loop rural economy that links local production directly to local consumption:
- **Procurement:** RUDI buys food grains, spices, and pulses directly from small and marginal farmers in cash, eliminating middlemen and securing higher margins for agriculturalists.
- **Processing:** The raw produce is transported to village-level processing centers operated by local women workers, where it is cleaned, quality-tested, graded, and packaged under the "RUDI" brand name.
- **Distribution ("RUDIbens"):** Packaged goods are distributed by a network of trained women micro-entrepreneurs known as "RUDIbens". Equipped with sales kits, mobile booking tools, and sales routes, RUDIbens sell these daily kitchen staples directly to households within their local communities.

► 3. Challenges and Strategic Solutions

- RUDI faced logistical constraints including limited working capital, lack of cold-storage infrastructure, inventory spoilage, and competition from cheap, unbranded local commodities. To overcome these, RUDI implemented digital technology tools (SMS-based inventory booking) and introduced affordable, smaller pack sizes tailored to daily village wage earners.

► 4. Key Takeaways and Analytical Results

- **Women Empowerment and Wealth Retention:** The RUDI model creates local employment for thousands of rural women, ensuring that financial capital circulates locally within rural communities rather than draining into urban corporate networks.
- **Inclusive Business Model:** Demonstrates how social entrepreneurship can build a self-sustaining, profitable rural distribution ecosystem that serves Bottom-of-the-Pyramid (BOP) consumers

► CASE STUDY 3: FMCG IN SMALL PACKS DRIVING SALES IN RURAL INDIA

► 1. Case Background and the "Sachet Revolution"

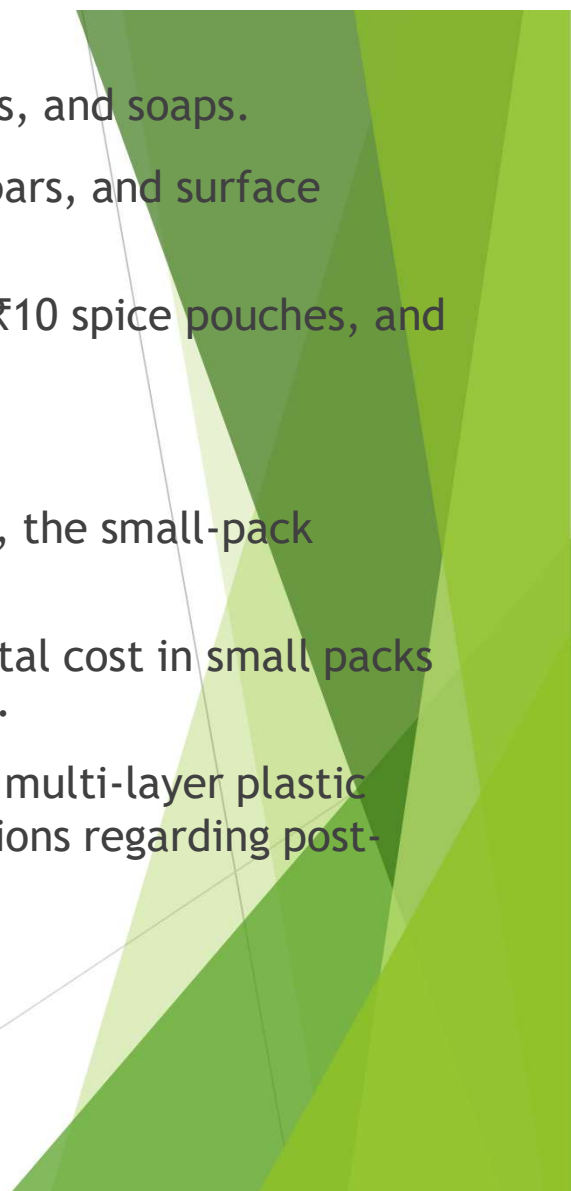
- Rural India accounts for over 65% of the nation's population, representing a massive market for Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG) companies like Hindustan Unilever (HUL), Procter & Gamble (P&G), CavinKare, Dabur, and Britannia. However, entering rural markets historically presented a major obstacle: rural consumers depend primarily on daily or weekly wage labor, resulting in fluctuating cash flows and low single-transaction purchasing power.
- The concept of "Small Packs" (popularly called the **Sachet Revolution**) was pioneered in the 1980s when CavinKare introduced **Re 1 Chik Shampoo sachets**, completely altering Indian consumer buying behavior.

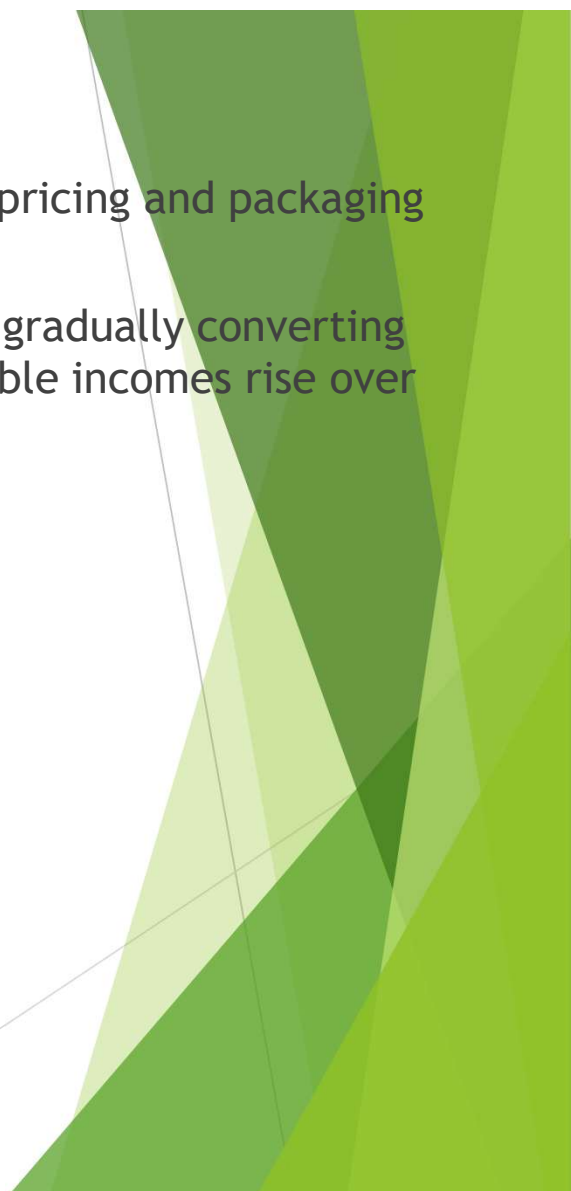
▶ 2. Marketing Logic Behind Low-Unit Price (LUP) Packaging

- ▶ FMCG companies use low-unit pricing strategies to drive rural market adoption through specific behavioral principles:
- ▶ **Overcoming Cash Flow Barriers:** While a rural daily wage earner cannot spend ₹150-₹200 upfront on a 200ml shampoo bottle or 500g detergent carton, spending ₹1, ₹2, or ₹5 on a single-use sachet fits their daily household earnings.
- ▶ **Risk Reduction and Trial Generation:** Small, affordable packs lower the financial risk for first-time rural buyers, encouraging them to try branded goods instead of unbranded, adulterated local alternatives.
- ▶ **Portability and Hygiene:** Single-use sachets prevent product spoilage, leakage, and wastage in rural environments where storage space or refrigeration may be lacking.

▶ 3. Category Expansion Across FMCG Sectors

- ▶ Following shampoo sachets, FMCG firms expanded low-unit price formatting across almost all product categories:

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- ▶ **Personal Care:** Re 1 to ₹5 packs of toothpaste, hair oils, fairness creams, and soaps.
 - ▶ **Home Care:** ₹5 and ₹10 small sachets of washing powder, dishwashing bars, and surface cleaners.
 - ▶ **Food & Beverages:** ₹2 coffee sachets, ₹5 biscuit packs (e.g., Parle-G), ₹10 spice pouches, and ₹5 miniature cold drink bottles.
 - ▶ **4. Challenges: Margins and Environmental Impact**
 - ▶ Despite driving massive volume sales and high rural market penetration, the small-pack strategy poses two critical long-term challenges:
 - ▶ **Margin Pressure:** Packaging costs account for a higher percentage of total cost in small packs compared to bulk packs, shrinking net profit margins for manufacturers.
 - ▶ **Plastic Waste Management:** Hundreds of millions of non-biodegradable multi-layer plastic sachets end up in rural landfills, prompting stricter government regulations regarding post-consumer plastic waste management.



► 5. Key Takeaways and Analytical Results

- **Volume-Driven Growth:** Small packs serve as the single most effective pricing and packaging innovation for penetrating rural, low-income markets.
- **Consumer Upgrading:** Small packs act as an entry-level market bridge, gradually converting rural consumers to larger, higher-value product formats as rural disposable incomes rise over time.